

Reference / Lookup Tables Documentation

Introduction

Reference and Lookup Tables store static or semi-static data that provides standardized values used throughout Business Central and Azure SQL systems.

These tables ensure **data consistency**, simplify reporting, and support **validation rules** by centralizing lists of predefined options.

In Business Central, reference tables are used to define elements such as:

- **Payment Terms** – e.g., Net 30, Net 60, COD
- **Shipping Agents** – e.g., UPS, FedEx, DHL
- **Currencies** – e.g., USD, EUR, GBP
- **Country/Region Codes** – e.g., US, CA, MX
- **Reason Codes** – e.g., Damaged, Returned, Backordered

Proper documentation of these tables ensures that business rules are enforced across all modules and integrations, including Power Platform apps, Azure Data Services, and reporting pipelines.

Diagram Components

The diagram will highlight the relationships between reference tables and core transactional tables like `SalesHeader` and `SalesLine`.

Component	Description
Reference Table	Stores standardized values used in drop-downs or validation rules.
Code Field	The unique identifier for each reference record (e.g., <code>Code</code> , <code>ID</code>).
Description Field	Text explanation of the code value.
Relationship Link	Connects transactional table fields to the related reference table.
Static Values	Predefined values maintained by system administrators or business rules.

Modeling Symbol Definitions

Symbol	Representation
Orange Table Box	Indicates a reference or lookup table.
Bold Field	Primary key for the reference table (e.g., Code).
Solid Line →	Mandatory relationship between transactional and reference table.
Dashed Line →	Optional relationship where value may be NULL.
Dropdown Icon	Represents controlled value selection from the reference table.

Diagram Example

This example shows how Business Central reference tables connect to transactional tables:

- `SalesHeader.PaymentTermsCode` → `PaymentTerms.Code`
- `SalesHeader.ShippingAgentCode` → `ShippingAgent.Code`
- `SalesHeader.CurrencyCode` → `Currency.Code`
- `SalesLine.ReasonCode` → `ReasonCode.Code`

Reference/LookUp Tables Documentation

Introduction

Reference/Lookup tables are small, static tables containing predefined values used to standardize and validate input in database systems. It provides centralized data for consistency across systems, support data integrity by limiting values in related tables, and simplify code maintenance by reducing hardcoded logic. These are commonly employed in applications, for example as:

Diagram Components

Typically found in reference/Lookup table documentation:

- **Tables:** Static datasets providing lookup values (eg. PaymentTerms, CountryRegion)
- **Columns:** Attributes within tables that store individual values
- **Primary Keys (PK):** Fields uniquely identifying each record in table
- **Foreign Keys (FK):** Fields creating relationships to related tables through reference keys
- **Example Values:** Sample data demonstrating potential elements in reference tables

Modeling Symbol Definitions

Symbol	Representation
Tables	Tables
Column Names	Bold column (PK)
➤ ➡ ➤	Foreign key relationships between two tables
Orange Border	Orange border—lookup tables

Diagram Example

